

there was a lot of mismanagement, which led to the relative failure of the new machine. Markkula sensed the trouble Apple might land into and hired many well-known corporate managers to make Apple a “real company.” However, things kept getting difficult as the sales of the Apple III kept falling, and Apple was forced to lay off 40 employees, the first ever layoff at Apple Computer.

Though it might sound like a very odd problem today, the buyers of computers at that time had no idea what could be done with it. It was only the novelty of owning the latest and the greatest and of having a cool Apple product that kept the sales going. It wasn’t a good prospect for the company from the future perspective. Things took a drastic change for the better when the first word processing program called AppleWriter, developed by Paul Lukas, hit the stores. It worked in tandem with the first printer from Apple called Silentype and gave businesses and schools a reason to use computers in their daily tasks. Then came the other applications—a stock market package, a chequebook-balancing application, and finally, Visicalc—the first ever computer spreadsheet, the beginning of wonderful things. Sales doubled!

1.2 Glorious Times

Xerox PARC (Palo Alto Research Center), the highly secretive lab of geniuses in the field of computing, wanted Jobs to visit their R&D labs along with his comrades to have a look at what the engineers were working on and see if they could work out a partnership. Jobs was only too happy to oblige them. The significance of this moment in the history of personal computing cannot be overstated. This visit was the reason personal computing is what it is today.

When Steve Jobs saw how those engineers had taken the way people could interact with computers to a whole new dimension, he was excited beyond measure. “Why aren’t you doing anything with this? This is the greatest thing! This is revolu-